

The Iceberg

Only ten percent is above the waterline, and the iceberg always moves in the direction of the base. Walk a shallow request down to meaning.

1 Your example

2 MIN

Whose request are you deepening? Their arrival sentence, verbatim

2 Above the line: the ask

THE KNOWN CONVERSATION

What do they ask for, in their exact words?

Where the market competes and price wars live.

Compressed to five words or fewer

3 Below the line: the want

THE HIDDEN CONVERSATION

What would they admit wanting, if asked kindly?

The emotional outcome. Competitors claim this level too.

Compressed to five words or fewer

4 The base: the meaning

THE UNKNOWN CONVERSATION

What does it MEAN to them, never said out loud?

Only you can see this level. If it comes easily, it is still the want.

Compressed to five words or fewer

The fork question: your version of 'shallow or deep?'

The base question: 'Do you want [the ask], or do you want [the meaning]?'